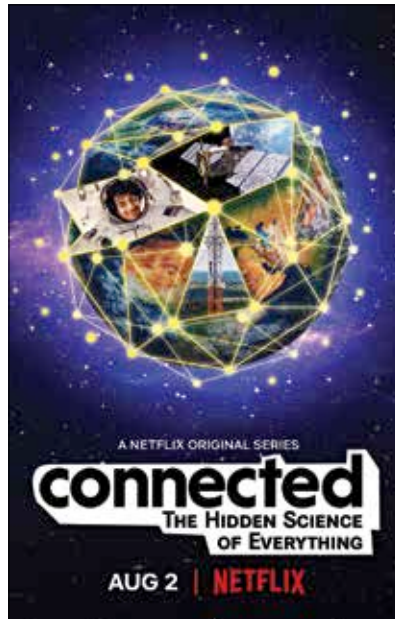


TV SHOW

Connected

★★★★☆ | There are three shows called Connected available on Netflix, we are talking about the docuseries here. The show will give you an entirely new perspective on some of the pressing issues that we are dealing with. For example, the first episode follows a roundabout journey that shows in the end how much humans depend on surveillance for survival as a species. Similarly, other episodes deal with dust, clouds, numbers and even poop, exploring all the strange connections. The series mostly focuses on science, but there is also a little history thrown in for good measure. The show explores some stunning connections, such as those between bird behavior and predicting weather, or tax calculations and classical music. Each episode is a breathtaking journey around the world, and the visuals are top notch,



with masterful use of drones, 360 degree cameras, animation, typography and timelapses. The host, Latif Nasser has a deep and genuine curiosity that is infectious, and the docuseries does not shy away from showing his weird spontaneous moments, such as finding

fossilised diatoms on the bottom of an ancient lake bed in the middle of the Sahara desert, and immediately deciding to find out what it tastes like (frozen-dried marshmallows apparently). If you liked Freakonomics or Quirkology, this series is in the same zone of finding bizarre, interesting and unexpected relationships between seemingly different things. The series is much more fun and infused with more enthusiasm than other science docuseries, such as Explained, and if you enjoyed The World according to Jeff Goldblum, then this one is a must watch. The recipe for mixing history and science the way Connected does, was first done by a BBC series in the late 1970s called Connections. The host, James Burke was the original popular science reporter and author, who managed to capture some of the most stunning shots in broadcast history, including one where a Saturn V rocket blasts off to the Moon as if on command. There are ten episodes in the first season, all of which are available on this month's DVD.

TV SHOW

WandaVision

★★★★☆ | WandaVision is Marvel Studios' first foray into making a TV series, and considering all the hype they get surrounding their movies, you can bet that expectations were high for WandaVision. Launching 18 months after their previous project, Spider-Man: Far from Home, WandaVision's first few episodes left everyone quite confused. Of course, confusing doesn't necessarily mean it wasn't entertaining, it definitely was. It just left everyone with a lot more questions than answers.

We'll keep this review as spoiler-free as we can, but essentially, when you start watching WandaVision, you feel like you're watching a sitcom from the 1950s. Even the trailers for the show indicated as much. As you progress



through the season though, you'll realise that this was the intention all along. And of course, there's something sinister going on behind the scenes.

The premise of the show is that Wanda and Vision have settled down

in a suburban town called Westview, to enjoy a "normal" life together. This, to anyone who has watched all the MCU movies to date, is quite confusing. Basic questions like how and why pop up the moment you start watching episode 1. Nevertheless, the initial few episodes are a fun ride with their sitcom vibe and Wanda magicking her way through life while also trying to keep it a secret from the nosy neighbours. By the end of said initial episodes though, you will have even more questions. Thankfully, a lot of them are answered as you progress through the season. The role of the time period is important, but we can't really explain more without giving away spoilers.

The show is littered with easter eggs for those who enjoy hunting them, for the rest you can always look them up online after watching an episode. Overall WandaVision is an impressive limited series debut from Marvel Studios and Disney, and we're looking forward to what they do next.